ECHO WARS | FACTION 1 OF 4 | RTS BASE UNITS

Awakened Ones
Unit Renders & Cards

Canonical images and unit cards for all four Awakened base units - with every earlier version kept beside the chosen one, so the pick can be revisited later.



Above: Wandbearers of Echo, canonical squad shot - the card illustration. Three hooded models, wands lit, in the faction's blue-grey gloom.

WHAT IS IN THIS DOCUMENT

One card per unit - cost, stats, abilities, passives, doctrine and field lore - followed by a version gallery for every unit that went through more than one render. The version marked **CANONICAL** is the current pick. Alternates are marked **ALT** and kept at full size, not as thumbnails, so they can be judged fairly later.

Only one cost in this faction is locked: the Wandbearers at **3 Resonance**. Every other cost is provisional and will move in balance testing. Abilities carried over from the parked card battler are flagged where their RTS adaptation is still to be designed.

Unit	Role	Tier	Cost	Versions inside
Wandbearers of Echo	Support	Core	3 - LOCKED	Canonical portrait + squad, 2 alt portraits, alt squad, dressed-down variant, 3 baselines
Sigil Keeper	Control / Anchor	Core	3 - provisional	Canonical only
Veil Walker	Flank	Core	4 - provisional	Canonical v3, alt v1, alt v2, baseline
Mirror Sentinel	Tank / Reflect	Elite	4 - provisional	Canonical v2, alt v1

FACTION VISUAL LANGUAGE

One army, read at a glance

The four units were finished in-faction on purpose, so the Awakened would lock a single visual language before any other faction starts. These rules now carry forward to Loopbound, the Architects of Collapse and the Forgotten Flame - each with its own palette, but the same discipline.

LOCKED RULES FROM THE PILOT

- **Palette:** slate-blue and grey, over near-black blue-grey gloom. No warm light, no bright backgrounds.
- **Uniform robes:** one robe set per faction. A unit belongs to the faction first and to its role second.
- **Rank through glyphs, not gear:** a step up in seniority is shown with glowing glyph markings on hems, sleeves and armour - never by adding tools, pouches or clutter to the robes.
- **Grounded core troops:** core units look workmanlike and field-worn. Epic scale is reserved for elites and heroes.
- **One signature item per unit:** the Wandbearer's wand, the Veil Walker's orb, the Mirror Sentinel's mirror shield. The item carries the silhouette.
- **Squads are squads:** the Wandbearers field as a 3-5 model squad and get a squad shot for the card. Single-model units get a single portrait.

HOW TO USE THE GALLERIES

Each gallery page keeps the canonical render largest in the card section and repeats it small in the gallery for direct comparison. If a later decision reverses a pick, note the new canonical version from the caption - captions use plain working descriptions, so the set can be handed to Don or a modeller without translation.

WORLD-FIT NOTE

There are no tanks in Nytherra. The Wandbearer field lore that once mentioned rival tanks has been rewritten to rival war-hosts in this document, and that wording is the one to use everywhere from here on.

AWAKENED ONES - CORE - SUPPORT

Wandbearers of Echo



CANONICAL Portrait v3 - dark-skinned man, hooded, wand with blue resonance orb, deep gloom. This is the baseline Echo chose.

3	3-5		
RESONANCE - LOCKED	SQUAD MODELS		
240	**12 in**	**+2**	
HP / MODEL	RANGE	WILLPOWER	

ABILITIES

- **Resonance Pulse (Active)** - a steadying pulse; nearby allies regenerate and shake off panic.
- **Dispel Loop (Reaction)** - negates illusion, psychic and rage effects within its radius.
- **Recalibrate Field (Support)** - removes debuffs and restores 1 Willpower.

PASSIVES

- **Low Signature Presence** - enemies are less likely to target Wandbearers directly.
- **Echo Chain** - chained units emit a Collapse Wave.

Proposal - test later, not locked: Wandbearers lose their attack entirely and instead reflect incoming attacks. It fits the doctrine - remind, not conquer - but the Mirror Sentinel already owns Reflection at 30% damage return, so the two would need clear differentiation before this can be adopted. Balance implications are untested.

> They were the first to hear the field remember itself - listeners who survived the Collapse with their attention intact. Now they walk Nytherra's broken places with tuned wands: not weapons, but instruments. Where a Wandbearer stands, resonance steadies. They do not conquer the field. They remind it what it is.

"One of them stood between two rival war-hosts, closed his eyes, and began the Resonance Pulse. In the silence, both lines laid down their arms and wept."

Field lore rewritten for world fit - the earlier version mentioned tanks, which do not exist in Nytherra.

Every Wandbearer version, kept

Two portrait directions were tried before the canonical pick. The woman versions are not wrong art - they are a different unit reading - so they stay in the record in case a second Wandbearer variant is wanted later.



CANONICAL Squad v2 - three hooded men, wands lit. Card illustration.



ALT Squad v1 - three women. Superseded when the unit was locked as men.



ALT Portrait v1 - woman, brighter tones. First render; too bright for the faction gloom.



ALT Portrait v2 - woman, darker gloom. Tone fixed, gender still wrong for the lock.



CANONICAL Portrait v3 - the chosen baseline carried through.

The starting points Echo supplied

These are the references the renders were built from. They stay in the document so a future artist can see what was asked for, not only what came back.



CHOSEN BASELINE Echo's upload - dark-skinned man. The reference the canonical portrait follows.



BASELINE Echo's original upload - hooded woman with wand. Starting point for v1 and v2.



VARIANT Dressed-down field variant - three men in weathered clothing, less formal robes.



BASELINE Echo's second starting point - same unit, plainer clothing. Kept as the low-key alternative to the formal robe set.

Open choice for later: formal robe set (canonical) or dressed-down field clothing as the in-game squad look. Both are preserved here; no decision is needed yet.

Sigil Keeper



CANONICAL Hooded figure, face in shadow, two floating rune-etched sigil plates, scroll cases on the belt. Only version - no alternates were generated.

3	1
RESONANCE - PROVISIONAL	MODEL

320	85	+1
HP	DAMAGE	WILLPOWER

ABILITIES

- **Anchor Field (Active)** - deploys two floating sigil plates; enemies inside the radius lose 20% speed.

Further abilities are still to be designed in the RTS pass. The Sigil Keeper was rendered once and accepted, so this page is a single-version record rather than a gallery.

ROLE IN THE FACTION

Where the Wandbearers steady a squad, the Keeper holds ground. It is the Awakened control piece: it does not chase, it decides where the fight slows down.

> Where the Wandbearers listen, the Sigil Keepers inscribe. They carry the plates that remember the field's true shape - and where they set them down, the world holds still. Armies have broken against ground a Keeper decided would not move.

"The field does not need to be commanded. It needs to be reminded."

Veil Walker



CANONICAL v3 - uniform faction robes, subtle glowing rank glyphs on hem and sleeves, no gear, Veil Orb in hand.

4	1
RESONANCE - PROVISIONAL	MODEL - SINGLE

300	120	Fast
HP	DAMAGE	SPEED

SIGNATURE ITEM

Veil Orb - a sphere of bound veil-mist. It shows the Walker the seams between the Veil and the Field. The orb is her only carried item; the robes stay clean by design.

ABILITIES

- **Veil Step (Active)** - slips between the Veil and the Field; untouchable mid-step, reappearing where attention is not.

Veil Step began as a lane-switching mechanic in the parked card battler. Its RTS adaptation is still to be designed - the description above is the fiction, not a finished rule.

WHY V3 WON

v1 read as a cover hero - too epic for a core troop, even as a single model. v2 fixed the scale but broke the uniform robe set and added scout gear. v3 keeps the faction robes, removes all extra tools, and lets the glyphs carry her slightly higher rank.

> The Walkers go where the field is thinnest - the seams between what is and what was. They do not cross battlefields; they step around them, arriving where the enemy's attention isn't. Every army has a blind side. The Veil Walkers live there.

"She does not choose a side. She chooses the moment."

From epic to core troop in three passes



CANONICAL v3 - uniform robes, glyph rank marks, orb only. Grounded core troop.



ALT v1 - the first render. Card was approved, image judged too epic.



ALT v2 - dressed-down scout. Closer in tone, but robes diverged from the faction set and extra gear crept back in.



BASELINE Echo's original upload. Supplied as the starting reference; not itself selected as canon.

The rule this unit set for the rest of the roster: **grounded first, epic reserved for elites and heroes.** A single-model core troop still reads as a core troop.

AWAKENED ONES - ELITE - TANK / REFLECT

Mirror Sentinel



CANONICAL v2 - mirror-plate construct, tattered slate-blue faction cape, glowing glyph etchings in the armour, mirror tower shield unchanged.

4	1
RESONANCE - PROVISIONAL	MODEL

380	90	Slow
HP	DAMAGE	SPEED

SIGNATURE ITEM

Mirror Shield - a tower shield of polished mirror-plate. It is the unit. Every revision left it untouched.

ABILITIES

- **Reflection (Passive)** - reflects 30% of incoming damage back to the attacker.

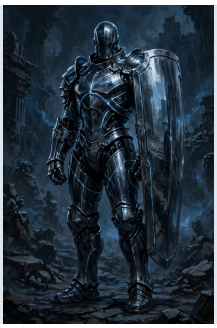
Further abilities are still to be designed in the RTS pass.

WHAT CHANGED IN V2

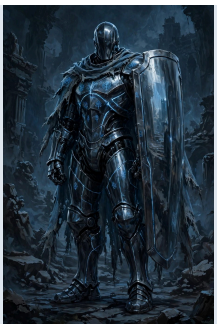
v1 was already close. v2 added only two things: the faction cape over the armour, so the construct belongs visibly to the Awakened, and glyph etchings in the plate, so its rank reads at tabletop distance. Nothing else moved.

> The Sentinels are the Awakened's answer to violence: a mirror. They do not advance. They do not strike first. They stand - and return what is given. Every army that has faced a Sentinel line has, in the end, fought itself.

"To strike it is to instruct it."



ALT v1 - no cape, no glyphs. Beautiful, but under-marked as Awakened.



CANONICAL v2 - cape and glyphs added, shield untouched.

STATUS & NEXT DECISIONS

What is locked, what is still open

LOCKED

- Wandbearers cost **3 Resonance** in the RTS squad framing (3-5 models).
- Wandbearer canonical look: dark-skinned man, hooded, darker gloom, wand with blue resonance orb.
- Veil Walker is a woman, single model, signature item is the Veil Orb.
- Veil Walker and the faction generally: uniform robes, no extra gear, rank shown by glyphs.
- Mirror Sentinel signature item is the mirror shield only; v2 cape and glyphs are part of canon.
- Field lore says rival war-hosts. There are no tanks in Nytherra.
- Core troops stay grounded; epic is reserved for elites and heroes.

STILL TO CHOOSE LATER

	Decision	Options preserved in this document
[ ]	Wandbearer squad clothing	Formal robe set (canonical) or dressed-down field clothing
[ ]	Wandbearer woman renders	Retire them, or reuse as a second variant unit
[ ]	Sigil Keeper, Veil Walker, Mirror Sentinel costs	Currently 3 / 4 / 4, all provisional pending balance testing
[ ]	RTS adaptations	Veil Step plus second abilities for Sigil Keeper and Mirror Sentinel
[ ]	Wandbearer reflect proposal	Test no-attack / reflect against Mirror Sentinel's Reflection - differentiation required first

NEXT FACTION

Loopbound is next. The same format applies: canonical portrait (plus squad shot where the unit fields as a squad), a card with cost, story and abilities, and a gallery that keeps every version. Heroes stay parked until all four factions' base units are done.

Source renders are held in the EchoPath unit-renders working folder. This document is the review copy - the renders themselves remain the production assets.